

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Document-Based Question

US.43 — Describe the impact of the Great Depression on the American people, including mass unemployment, migration, and Hoovervilles.

US.45 — Analyze the impact of the relief, recovery, and reform efforts of President Franklin D. Roosevelt’s New Deal programs, including: • Agricultural Adjustment Act • Civilian Conservation Corps • Securities and Exchange Commission • Fair Labor Standards Act • Social Security • Federal Deposit Insurance • Tennessee Valley Authority • Works Progress Administration • National Recovery Administration

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt’s “court packing” attempt.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Analyze the three primary sources below. Then respond to the prompt using evidence from ALL THREE documents and your own historical knowledge.

The sources

Document A

National Industrial Recovery Act, Section 1 (Declaration of Policy), June 16, 1933 (National Archives, public domain)

“A national emergency productive of widespread unemployment and disorganization of industry, which burdens interstate and foreign commerce...is hereby declared to exist. It is hereby declared to be the policy of Congress to remove obstructions to the free flow of interstate and foreign commerce which tend to diminish the amount thereof; and to provide for the general welfare by promoting the organization of industry for the purpose of cooperative action among trade groups...”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document B

National Labor Relations Act (Wagner Act), Section 1 (Findings and Policy), July 5, 1935 (National Archives, public domain)

“The inequality of bargaining power between employees who do not possess full freedom of association or actual liberty of contract, and employers who are organized in the corporate or other forms of ownership association substantially burdens and affects the flow of commerce...It is hereby declared to be the policy of the United States to eliminate the causes of certain substantial obstructions to the free flow of commerce...by protecting the exercise by workers of full freedom of association, self-organization, and designation of representatives of their own choosing.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

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P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document C

FDR, Message to Congress on Tax Revision, June 19, 1935 (FDR Presidential Library, public domain)

“Our revenue laws have operated in many ways to the unfair advantage of the few, and they have done little to prevent an unjust concentration of wealth and economic power...The very wealthy may be able to hire the ablest tax lawyers so that the letter of the tax law is followed but not the spirit...Inherited economic power is as inconsistent with the ideals of this generation as inherited political power was inconsistent with the ideals of the generation which established our Government.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT C

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

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Who is speaking, and how
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The question

PROMPT: Using all three documents and your knowledge of the New Deal (1933–1938), construct an argument that answers: How did the New Deal evolve from the First New Deal (1933–1934) to the Second New Deal (1935–1938), and what does this evolution reveal about FDR's response to political pressure from critics on both the left and right? In your response, you MUST: 1. Analyze each document using the HIPP framework — at least ONE HIPP element per document. 2. Place each document within the First or Second New Deal phase and explain what governing philosophy it reflects. 3. Construct a central argument using all three documents AND at least two outside historical facts explaining how the shift from Document A to Documents B and C reflects a meaningful philosophical and political evolution in the New Deal. 4. Evaluate: Was the Second New Deal a genuine ideological shift toward redistribution and worker empowerment, or primarily a political strategy to neutralize critics like Huey Long and the Supreme Court?

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document A		
Document B		
Document C		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

